

Chapter 8

Monitoring and Managing Linux Processes

- Listing Processes

The **top** command in Linux is a powerful utility used to display a **dynamic, real-time** view of the **running system, including active processes, CPU usage, memory utilization, load averages, and more.**

```
[user@host ~]$ top
PID USER PR NI VIRT RES SHR S %CPU %MEM TIME+ COMMAND
  1 root 20  0 244344 13684 9024 S  0.0  0.7 0:02.46 systemd
  2 root 20  0      0      0      0 S  0.0  0.0 0:00.00 kthreadd
...output omitted...
```

ps Stands for "**process status**" and provides a snapshot of active processes at the moment the command is run

```
[user@host ~]$ ps aux
USER      PID %CPU %MEM    VSZ   RSS TTY      STAT START   TIME COMMAND
...output omitted...
root         2  0.0  0.0      0      0 ?        S    11:57   0:00 [kthreadd]
student  3448  0.0  0.2 266904  3836 pts/0    R+   18:07   0:00 ps aux
...output omitted...
```

```
[user@host ~]$ ps aux
USER      PID %CPU %MEM    VSZ   RSS TTY      STAT START   TIME COMMAND
root         1  0.1  0.1 51648 7504 ?        Ss   17:45   0:03 /usr/lib/systemd/
syst
root         2  0.0  0.0      0      0 ?        S    17:45   0:00 [kthreadd]
root         3  0.0  0.0      0      0 ?        S    17:45   0:00 [ksoftirqd/0]
root         5  0.0  0.0      0      0 ?        S<   17:45   0:00 [kworker/0:0H]
root         7  0.0  0.0      0      0 ?        S    17:45   0:00 [migration/0]
...output omitted...
[user@host ~]$ ps lax
F  UID    PID PPID PRI  NI   VSZ   RSS WCHAN  STAT TTY      TIME COMMAND
4   0      1    0  20   0 51648 7504 ep_pol Ss   ?      0:03 /usr/lib/
systemd/
1   0      2    0  20   0      0      0 kthrea S    ?      0:00 [kthreadd]
1   0      3    2  20   0      0      0 smpboo S    ?      0:00 [ksoftirqd/0]
1   0      5    2   0 -20      0      0 worker S<   ?      0:00 [kworker/0:0H]
1   0      7    2 -100  -      0      0 smpboo S    ?      0:00 [migration/0]
...output omitted...
[user@host ~]$ ps -ef
UID      PID PPID  C STIME TTY          TIME CMD
root      1    0  0 17:45 ?          00:00:03 /usr/lib/systemd/systemd --
switched-ro
root      2    0  0 17:45 ?          00:00:00 [kthreadd]
root      3    2  0 17:45 ?          00:00:00 [ksoftirqd/0]
root      5    2  0 17:45 ?          00:00:00 [kworker/0:0H]
root      7    2  0 17:45 ?          00:00:00 [migration/0]
...output omitted...
```

Name	Flag	Kernel-defined state name and description
Running	R	TASK_RUNNING: The process is either executing on a CPU or waiting to run. Process can be executing user routines or kernel routines (system calls), or be queued and ready when in the <i>Running</i> (or <i>Runnable</i>) state.
Sleeping	S	TASK_INTERRUPTIBLE: The process is waiting for some condition: a hardware request, system resource access, or signal. When an event or signal satisfies the condition, the process returns to <i>Running</i> .
	D	TASK_UNINTERRUPTIBLE: This process is also <i>Sleeping</i> , but unlike S state, does not respond to signals. Used only when process interruption may cause an unpredictable device state.
	K	TASK_KILLABLE: Identical to the uninterruptible D state, but modified to allow a waiting task to respond to the signal that it should be killed (exit completely). Utilities frequently display <i>Killable</i> processes as D state.
	I	TASK_REPORT_IDLE: A subset of state D . The kernel does not count these processes when calculating load average. Used for kernel threads. Flags TASK_UNINTERRUPTIBLE and TASK_NOLOAD are set. Similar to TASK_KILLABLE, also a subset of state D . It accepts fatal signals.
Stopped	T	TASK_STOPPED: The process has been <i>Stopped</i> (suspended), usually by being signaled by a user or another process. The process can be continued (resumed) by another signal to return to <i>Running</i> .
	T	TASK_TRACED: A process that is being debugged is also temporarily <i>Stopped</i> and shares the same T state flag.
Zombie	Z	EXIT_ZOMBIE: A child process signals its parent as it exits. All resources except for the process identity (PID) are released.
	X	EXIT_DEAD: When the parent cleans up (<i>reaps</i>) the remaining child process structure, the process is now released completely. This state will never be observed in process-listing utilities.

Controlling Jobs

Job control is a feature of the shell which allows a single shell instance to run and manage multiple commands.

Running Jobs in the Background

```
[user@host ~]$ sleep 10000 &  
[1] 5947  
[user@host ~]$
```

You can **display the list of jobs** that Bash is tracking for a particular session with the **jobs** command.

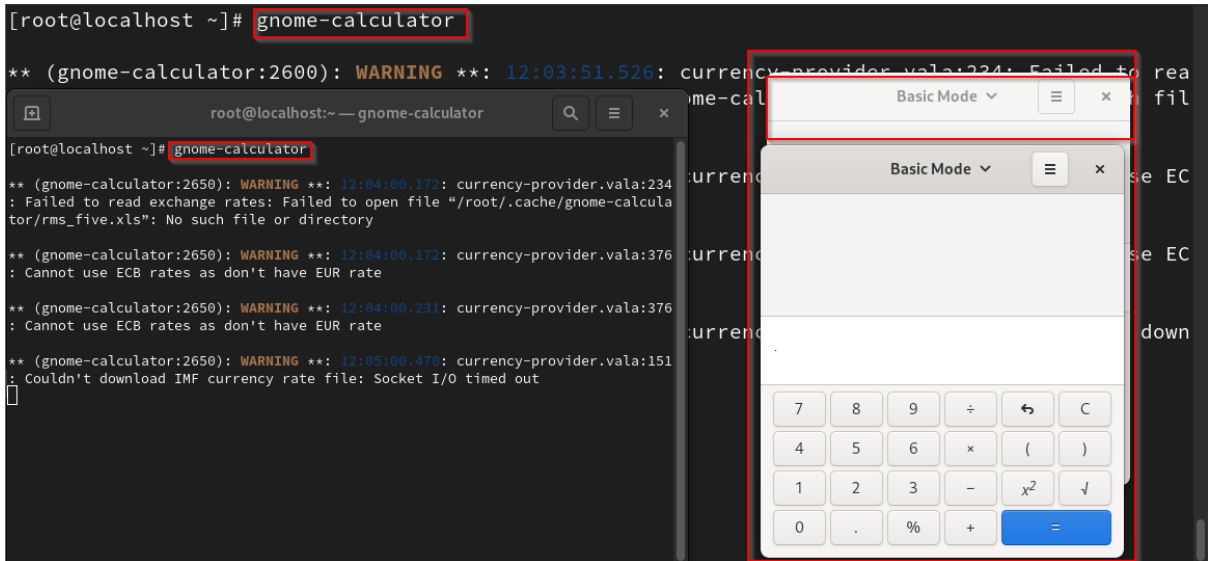
```
[user@host ~]$ jobs  
[1]+  Running                  sleep 10000 &  
[user@host ~]$
```

Killing Processes

```
[root@localhost ~]# ps  
  PID TTY          TIME CMD  
 2346 pts/0        00:00:00 bash  
 2467 pts/0        00:00:00 sleep  
 2584 pts/0        00:00:00 ps  
[root@localhost ~]# kill 2467  
[1]+  Terminated              sleep 10000  
[root@localhost ~]# ps  
  PID TTY          TIME CMD  
 2346 pts/0        00:00:00 bash  
 2594 pts/0        00:00:00 ps  
[root@localhost ~]#
```

To Create Multiple process gnome-calculator

```
[root@localhost ~]# gnome-calculator
```



```
[root@localhost ~]# ps -aux
```

root	2567	0.0	0.0	220984	1536	?	Ss	12:01	0:00	/usr/sbin/anacron -s
root	2600	0.5	3.5	794832	71236	pts/0	Sl+	12:03	0:00	gnome-calculator
root	2621	0.0	0.2	224108	5504	pts/1	Ss	12:03	0:00	bash
root	2650	0.4	3.5	794804	71012	pts/1	Sl+	12:03	0:00	gnome-calculator

To kill all Same Processes #killall “Common-process name”

```
[root@localhost ~]# killall gnome-calculator
```

To kill All Process that is running by a user

```
[root@localhost ~]# pkill -U student
```

To Kill all the terminal

```
[root@localhost ~]# who
root    seat0      2025-09-05 11:59 (login screen)
root    tty2       2025-09-05 11:59 (tty2)
student tty3       2025-09-05 12:23
[root@localhost ~]#
[root@localhost ~]# pkill -9 -t tty3
[root@localhost ~]# who
root    seat0      2025-09-05 11:59 (login screen)
root    tty2       2025-09-05 11:59 (tty2)
[root@localhost ~]#
```

Monitoring Process Activity

The **uptime** command is one way to display the current load average. It prints **the current time, how long the machine has been up, how many user sessions are running, and the current load average**

```
[root@localhost ~]# uptime
12:28:36 up 29 min,  2 users,  load average: 0.00, 0.04, 0.07
[root@localhost ~]#
```

The **lscpu** command can help you **determine how many CPUs** a system has.

```
[root@localhost ~]# lscpu
Architecture:          x86_64
CPU op-mode(s):        32-bit, 64-bit
Address sizes:         45 bits physical, 48 bits virtual
Byte Order:            Little Endian
CPU(s):                1
On-line CPU(s) list:   0
Vendor ID:             GenuineIntel
BIOS Vendor ID:        GenuineIntel
Model name:            Intel(R) Core(TM) i5-8500T CPU @ 2.10GHz
BIOS Model name:       Intel(R) Core(TM) i5-8500T CPU @ 2.10GHz
CPU family:            6
```